

2030 CENSUS QUESTIONNAIRE ASSISTANCE (CQA) REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

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1. Introduction

The United States Census Bureau (USCB) is a principal federal agency within the Department of Commerce (DOC) and serves as the Nation's primary source of statistics on the U.S. population, housing, and economy.

The USCB's major programs include periodic censuses, current surveys, and a wide range of reimbursable work performed on behalf of other agencies.

The reliable collection, preparation, tabulation, and dissemination of demographic and economic statistics are vital to USCB's overall mission and strategic objectives. To fulfill this critical mission and address the evolving data needs of its users, USCB increasingly relies on information technology (IT) to improve the timeliness and quality of its statistical products. USCB develops, processes, and maintains extensive collections of basic data about the nation's people and economy (e.g., over 100 million survey responses and administrative records collected across multiple years and regions). Additionally, the USCB relies on the ability to continuously update and maintain a national repository of geospatial data which serves as the foundation for all statistical data produced by the USCB.

Article I, Section 2 of the United States Constitution and 13 U.S.C. § 141, mandates that a nationwide census be conducted every ten (10) years to determine the appointment of representatives among the states. The Decennial Census is the nation's oldest and most comprehensive source of population data. Its primary objective is to count everyone once, only once, and in the right place.

In support of the 2030 Census, the USCB is seeking a Contractor to perform the requirements described in this document. Under the direction of the Government, the selected Contractor will be responsible for designing, testing, and operating an omni-channel contact center in support of the 2030 Census Questionnaire Assistance (2030 CQA) program, which also includes the 2028 Dress Rehearsal and 2030 Census operation, detailed in the 2030 Census Operational Plan (Attachment J-1).

Please note that the attachments referenced in this document are not currently included but will be attached in a future version release.

1.1. Census Questionnaire Assistance (CQA) Program Background

The 2030 CQA Program is a functional group within the USCB responsible for providing support to respondents through voice and chat channels. The program's purpose is to assist individuals in understanding and completing the Census questionnaire, addressing specific questions related to the form itself as well as Census policies and procedures.

The CQA Program supports both the 2030 Census and the 2028 Dress Rehearsal, which serves as a comprehensive test of operational readiness and system integration ahead of the Decennial Census. The USCB is currently preparing for the 2030 Census, which will be the 25th population

count in U.S. history and will include residents of all 50 states, the District of Columbia, and five U.S. territories.

1.2. 2030 CQA Program Objectives

The 2030 CQA Program will facilitate respondent participation during the 2030 Census by providing support across multiple communication channels (e.g., voice, voicebots, chat, chatbots). CQA will assist individuals in understanding and completing the Census questionnaire, including fielding questions and, in some cases, guiding respondents through the interview process.

The 2030 Census will follow a web-first operational model, encouraging respondents to complete the questionnaire online via the Census Web interface. To support this approach, the CQA program will provide assistance to respondents who experience difficulties with the online form, require clarification, or need alternative methods of response, such as requesting questionnaire status or paper questionnaire fulfillment.

The CQA Program will utilize both automated and live support across voice and chat channels. Automated services, such as Interactive Voice Response (IVR) systems and chatbots, will handle routine interactions such as frequently asked questions, providing questionnaire status updates, and paper questionnaire fulfillment. Customer Service Representatives (CSRs) will be available to handle both routine and more complex inquiries.

To enhance service delivery, the USCB is anticipating the integration of artificial intelligence (AI) technologies for both voice and chat assistance. These tools will be incorporated into the CQA technical solution to improve CSR efficiency by proactively assisting during phone and chat interactions and to enhance user experience while being monitored by CSRs.

The primary goals and objectives for the 2030 CQA Program are to:

- Handle more than 13.5 million inbound contacts (via voice and chat combined) over an operational period of approximately 4.5 months while meeting quality and service level expectations. For reference, over 50 percent of the 13.5 million inbound contacts (voice only) during 2020 CQA were received within the first four weeks of operations as detailed in the 2020 Census Questionnaire Assistance Operational Assessment Report (Attachment J-2).
- Leverage advanced technologies (e.g., AI) to proactively assist CSRs during live calls, chats and employ voicebots and chatbots wherever feasible to enhance service quality and operational efficiency, while also ensuring all solutions are cost-effective or deliver measurable cost savings.
- Provide assistance to respondents completing the 2030 Census questionnaire, including support for answering all required questions.
- Provide respondents with the option to submit their data over the phone utilizing a Census-developed data collection instrument.
- Provide questionnaire completion status to help respondents confirm whether their submission has been received and processed.

- Fulfill requests for paper questionnaire forms for respondents who prefer a non-digital response method.
- Address questions related to Census processes and operations, ensuring respondents receive accurate and timely information.
- Capture respondent interaction metadata and analytics to evaluate the performance and effectiveness of CQA operations.
- Develop and implement data-driven quality assurance methods to assess the accuracy and completeness of data captured during respondent interactions, ensuring CSRs, voicebots, and chatbots consistently deliver USCB-approved information.
- Provide specialized CQA-related operations support:
 - Group Quarters (GQ) operations – Voice-only assistance using an IVR system and live CSR support tailored to GQ needs. Group quarters are defined as places where people live or stay in a group living arrangement that is owned or managed by an organization providing housing and/or services for the residents.
 - Field Infrastructure operations – Voice-only assistance using an IVR system for Pre-employment (recruiting, application status, onboarding information) and Employee Support (IT support, payroll information, security incident) with the ability to route calls to other Census Bureau areas.

2. 2030 CQA Scope

The USCB is seeking to acquire a comprehensive contact center solution to support the 2030 CQA Program. The solution must encompass all necessary technology, infrastructure, personnel, and processes required to design, implement, test, refine, operate, and decommission the CQA contact center systems and facilities. The solution must be capable of supporting omni-channel respondent interactions, including voice and chat, and align with the USCB's operational and technical requirements. Additionally, the solution must align with industry best practices, and comply with all applicable USCB policies and regulations, and relevant federal laws.

The 2030 CQA procurement scope of work covers both the 2028 Dress Rehearsal (Attachment J-4) and 2030 Census (Attachment J-5). The 2028 Dress Rehearsal is a major field test by the USCB, acting as a simulation and operational dry run to ensure readiness for the 2030 Census. For the CQA Program, the following aspects are expected to be supported for the Dress Rehearsal and the 2030 Census:

- **Preparations for the 2028 Dress Rehearsal** – This encompasses all CQA aspects leading up to 2028 Dress Rehearsal live operations, including detailed planning, system development, obtaining an Authorization to Operate (ATO) and integration activities. It includes system testing aspects as well as recruiting and staffing to support operations during the Dress Rehearsal.
- **2028 Dress Rehearsal Live Operations** – The 2028 Dress Rehearsal will serve as a full-scale test of the CQA solution and will support respondent interactions from approximately

mid-March 2028 to the end of July 2028. This effort will test the CQA operational model, contact center systems, and procedures. It includes live testing of contact center operations, system performance, and respondent support workflows. The Dress Rehearsal provides an opportunity to validate CQA readiness for the 2030 Census while offering critical insights to refine the solution.

- **Preparations for the 2030 Census** – Following the Dress Rehearsal, lessons learned will be analyzed to refine and finalize the CQA systems design, integration, and operational planning for the 2030 Census. These preparations include scaling infrastructure, refining processes, performance testing, maintaining ATO, and preparing facilities and personnel for the CQA solution to support full 2030 Census operations.
- **2030 Census Live Operations** – The CQA solution will be fully deployed to support respondent interactions from approximately mid-March 2030 to the end of July 2030. After CQA operations are concluded, the contact center systems and facilities will be decommissioned and a comprehensive analysis of the CQA program will be conducted to support procurement closeout.

Also included in 2030 CQA procurement scope is specialized support (voice only) for non-CQA operations including GQ and Field Infrastructure, detailed in Respondent Services (Attachment J-7).

All work performed under this procurement shall be conducted within the Contiguous United States (CONUS).

3. 2030 CQA Solution Assumptions

This section outlines the Government's assumptions and plans for managing the 2030 CQA contact center operations. These assumptions inform the design, implementation, and oversight of the contact center solution and reflect the Government's intent to leverage cost-effective modern technologies and best practices to enhance operational efficiency and service quality.

3.1. Program Execution

The Government will maintain oversight of all aspects of procurement execution. Performance will be monitored and evaluated using the methods defined in the Quality Assurance and Surveillance Plan (QASP) (Attachment J-10), including formal deliverables, site visits, and Government feedback. The Government will issue requests for changes as needed and reserve the right to inspect and monitor all components of the contact center solution.

The Government retains the authority to review and approve all applications, system processes, designs and configuration changes prior to implementation. Additionally, the Government will review systems for compliance with applicable security policies, procedures, and audit requirements throughout the procurement.

To accommodate evolving operational needs or policy changes, the Government reserves the right to adjust priorities and redirect activities within the scope of the procurement. Only the Government is authorized to approve access to its networks and associated systems.

3.2. 2028 Dress Rehearsal and 2030 Census Operating Parameters

The Government plans to incorporate AI technologies to automate contact handling (voice and chat), streamline manual processes, and improve overall service quality and operational efficiency. This includes, but is not limited to, AI-enabled tools for quality management, workforce management, and agent assist.

The Government will require approval of any solutions and materials that may be presented to respondents during live operations.

The Government will provide approved FAQs, CSR scripts, and messaging in all required languages. Internal-facing requirements (e.g., help desk operations or Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for internal workflows) should be recommended by the Contractor.

Detailed operational parameters for both the 2028 Dress Rehearsal and 2030 Census, including duration, hours of operations, estimated contact volumes, and expected contact characteristics such as Average Handle Time (AHT) and distribution between contact type are provided in the following documents: 2028 CQA Dress Rehearsal (Attachment J-4), 2030 CQA Operations (Attachment J-5) and 2028 Dress Rehearsal and 2030 Expected Workload (Attachment J-6).

3.3. Facilities

The Government will not dictate location or number of contact centers and auxiliary facilities if they are located within CONUS locations. The Government will provide security requirements for the CQA facilities.

2030 CQA services may be performed at remote locations not directly managed by the Census Bureau, subject to any other approvals as required by Census Bureau policy. The COR may temporarily authorize performance of CQA services under this procurement at the Contractor's individual place of residence.

3.4. Advanced Technology Integration

The Government assumes the Contractor will incorporate advanced technologies, including AI, into the CQA solution where it is feasible to enhance productivity, improve service quality, and deliver measurable cost benefits. This includes leveraging AI-enabled tools for quality management, workforce optimization, and agent assist capabilities, as well as integrating AI solutions or voice and chat interactions to streamline manual processes and improve user experience. The Contractor is expected to propose and implement AI-driven enhancements that align with operational requirements and demonstrate efficiency gains and cost-effectiveness throughout the procurement lifecycle.

4. Task Areas

4.1. Task Area 1 – Procurement and Program Management

All procurement deliverables and work products shall be developed, produced, maintained, and submitted in full accordance with the requirements, formats, acceptance criteria, and performance standards established in Section XX – Deliverables and Performance and the Performance Matrix.

4.1.1. Procurement Management

The Contractor shall provide procurement management activities to support the establishment and execution of procurement governance, management processes, administrative controls, and operations necessary to manage and coordinate all procurement-administrative tasks as described below.

4.1.1.1. Procurement Governance

The Contractor shall support establishment and operation of the organizational structure, management processes, controls, and documentation practices required to oversee procurement execution and ensure compliance with applicable standards, policies, and Government procedures.

The Contractor shall:

1. Provide the overall management framework, governance, structure, and controls to effectively manage the requirements of this procurement.
2. Provide a Contractor Program Management Office (CPMO) dedicated exclusively to this procurement, including a Program Manager and a designated back-up, responsible for executing all management aspects; providing centralized oversight and communication; and ensuring contractor compliance with the requirements.
3. Develop, document, implement, maintain, and adhere to a Contract Management Plan (CMP).
4. Manage all technical and administrative requirements in alignment with recognized project management standards, including the latest publication of the Project Management Institute's (PMI) *The Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge (PMBOK®)*, and implement processes that incorporate governance and decision-making protocols; schedule, cost, and quality controls; issue and risk management; deliverable tracking; change management; and compliance verification.
5. Obtain formal CO approval before implementing any change to scope, cost, or schedule, and maintaining a detailed Change Log.

4.1.1.2. Staffing and Subcontractor Management

The Contractor shall support the recruiting, onboarding, supervision, retention and oversight of all personnel and subcontractor resources required for performance under this procurement.

297 The Contractor shall:

- 298 1. Develop, deliver, and maintain a Staffing Plan and Subcontractor Management Plan that is
299 to be submitted as a part of the CMP.
- 300 2. Develop, deliver, and maintain a comprehensive Staffing Matrix that is to be submitted as a
301 part of the Monthly Contract Administration Status Report (MCASR).
- 302 3. Maintain an up-to-date Internal Use Software (IUS) report that is to be submitted as a part
303 of the MCASR.
- 304 4. Recruit, vet, assign, manage, and supervise all personnel working under this procurement.
- 305 5. Provide only **U.S. Citizens** who are capable of obtaining a favorable USCB suitability
306 assessment.
- 307 6. Establish and execute onboarding processes for all personnel, including required
308 documentation, suitability submissions, and access requirements.
- 309 7. Initiate and monitor the Census Investigative Services (CIS) suitability assessment,
310 including conducting quality assurance reviews of all suitability documentation prior to
311 submission to CIS to ensure accuracy, completeness, and timeliness.
- 312 8. Obtain COR notification of a favorable suitability assessment for each staff member prior to
313 commencing work, accessing Government facilities or systems, or charging labor to the
314 procurement.
- 315 9. Provide notification, in writing, to the Contracting Officer's Representative (COR) of
316 personnel being offboarded as soon as possible but no later than twenty-four (24) hours
317 after the exit.
- 318 10. Retain personnel-related documentation and provide such records to the Government
319 upon request.
- 320 11. Maintain the required level of expertise and competency of all personnel by ensuring
321 individuals remain current with evolving technologies and by assuming full responsibility for
322 role-appropriate training and requiring personnel to maintain required professional
323 certifications, accreditations, and proficiencies, at no additional cost to the Government.
- 324 12. Provide oversight and tracking for all mandatory USCB and Decennial Program training,
325 ensuring all personnel complete required training prior to deadlines specified by the COR.
- 326 13. Provide the ability to meet surge requirements by rapidly augmenting staff and responding
327 to unforeseen, ad hoc, or shifting priorities.
- 328 14. Assist the Government with the timely tracking and receipt of Government Furnished
329 Equipment/Government Furnished Information (GFE/GFI), Government system accesses,
330 passwords, etc.
- 331 15. Comply with USCB physical and personnel security guidelines.

332 **4.1.1.3. Procurement Risk Management**

333 The Contractor shall support the proactive identification, assessment, mitigation, monitoring, and
334 escalation of risks and issues that could impact contractual performance, cost, schedule, quality,

or compliance. Procurement risks reported under this subsection shall be included in the Monthly Issue Risk & Issue Report.

The Contractor shall:

1. Maintain an active, documented risk management process, including identification, assessment, prioritization, mitigation, and monitoring of all procurement-execution risks.
2. Develop and maintain a Risk Register.
3. Develop and execute risk mitigation and/or avoidance plans in coordination with the COR and/or Contracting Officer (CO).
4. Report risks, issues, and mitigation plans in all required weekly and monthly reports.
5. Provide immediate notification to the COR and/or CO of any urgent or high-impact risks affecting cost, schedule, performance, compliance, or continuity.

4.1.1.4. Communication Management

The Contractor shall support the establishment of clear, timely, and collaborative communication channels, coordination mechanisms, and meeting cadences between the Contractor and Government to support effective procurement administration, decision-making, coordination, and documentation.

The Contractor shall:

1. Establish and maintain a Communication Plan.
2. Provide timely notifications of all scheduled and unscheduled events or issues impacting performance.
3. Establish escalation and crisis-handling procedures for root cause analysis and resolution, to the Government's satisfaction, of major issues.
4. Utilize Government-approved communication tools and file formats for all reporting and information exchange.
5. Maintain a Communications and Decision Log to track key communications and decisions.

4.1.2. Program Management

The Contractor shall provide program management activities to support integrated planning, monitoring, control, and coordination of program execution across schedule, quality, risk, readiness, and cross-team collaboration as described below.

4.1.2.1. Program Governance

The Contractor shall support the Contractor's use of Government-issued program governance artifacts, standards, and processes to ensure that all program execution activities conform to Decennial requirements, operational frameworks and oversight expectations.

The Contractor shall:

1. Leverage and align with USCB and Decennial governing artifacts, including the: 2030 Census Integration & Implementation Plan (IIP) (Attachment J-24); 2030 Census Operational Delivery Management Plan (ODMP) (Attachment J-25); the 2030 Census Test & Evaluation Master Plan (TEMP) (Attachment J-22); 2030 Census IT Defect Management Plan (Attachment J-26); Decennial Systems Engineering Management Plan (SEMP) (Attachment J-21); 2030 Census Program Requirements Management Plan (REMP) (Attachment J-23); and all other applicable Decennial program documents, plans, standards and governance requirements.
2. Implement and execute program change management processes.
3. Store all deliverables, work products, artifacts, and supporting documentation in the Government-specified document repository accessible to both the CPMO and the Government Program Management Office (GPMO).
4. Adhere to the USCB Rules of Behavior for Privileged Users policy which governs the conduct of all personnel with elevated privileges to Department of Commerce and USCB networks, data, information technology systems and resources.

4.1.2.2. Schedule Management

The Contractor shall support the development, integration, and maintenance of schedule artifacts and planning inputs required to coordinate work across the procurement, including the alignment of the Contractor Work Breakdown Structure (CWBS), Decennial Work Breakdown Structure (DWBS) (Attachment J-27), and the Decennial Integrated Master Schedule (IMS).

4.1.2.2.1. Contractor Work Breakdown Structure (CWBS)

The Contractor shall:

1. Develop, deliver, and maintain a detailed CWBS.
2. Provide and maintain a CWBS Dictionary.

4.1.2.2.2. Decennial IMS Inputs and Schedule Integration

The Contractor shall:

1. Provide all required schedule inputs to the Government for incorporation into the Decennial IMS, ensuring completeness, accuracy, and traceability to the CWBS and associated deliverables.
2. Assign unique CWBS identifiers to each schedule activity and milestone to maintain one-to-one traceability between the schedule, CWBS, deliverables, risks, and reporting.

4.1.2.3. Program Quality Management & QASP Performance

The Contractor shall support the monitoring, control, and continuous improvement of program execution and compliance with Government quality surveillance requirements, including development and maintenance of the Quality Control Plan (QCP), participation in QASP (Attachment J-10) activities and program-level defect prevention and resolution.

The Contractor shall:

1. Develop, deliver, maintain, and adhere to a QCP.
2. Assess and document quality assurance/quality control lessons learned throughout the lifecycle of the procurement.
3. Identify and report risks or issues that may impact QASP performance metrics, including staffing risks, workload changes, system constraints, and process challenges, along with mitigation strategies.
4. Provide advanced notice of any anticipated performance deviations from QASP standards, including justifications, impact assessment, and proposed mitigations.
5. Participate in a Monthly QASP Performance Meeting, as well as any other ad-hoc reviews that may arise during the monthly cycle, to review the Government's assessment of the Contractor's performance.
6. Prevent rework and ability to extend existing functionalities and features by planning and prioritizing appropriately.
7. Ensure key work products, deliverables and ad-hoc tasks are completed on time and in accordance with established requirements, schedules, and quality standards.
8. Work with Government stakeholders and GPMO to track and mitigate urgent defects as they occur.
9. Ensure that all defects are managed and tracked in a timely manner, that is accepted by the stakeholders and GPMO.

4.1.2.4. Program Risk & Issue Management

The Contractor shall support the identification, documentation, communication, and mitigation of risks and issues that may affect program-level performance or outcomes. Program-level risks reported under this subsection shall be included in the Monthly Risk & Issue Report.

The Contractor shall:

1. Identify, document, and communicate to the GPMO project risks, mitigations, contingencies, and issues.
2. Support/participate in and respond to USCB risk management activities. This includes responding to information requests, supporting processes or procedures, maintaining and/or updating documentation, and attending both scheduled and ad-hoc meetings.
3. Capture meeting notes and action items for program-level risk meetings that are jointly attended by federal and contractor staff and storing them in a centralized location that is accessible to all appropriate Government and Contractor management personnel.

4.1.3. Data Call and Audit Support

The Contractor shall facilitate the collection, analysis, and reporting of relevant data and information required for procurement audits or data calls.

The Contractor shall:

1. Support internal and external procurement audits on work performed under this procurement.
2. Support internal and external (e.g., Department of Commerce (DOC) & Government Accountability Office (GAO) inquiries) data calls related to work performed under this procurement.
3. Support the timely production and presentation of materials in support of Decennial Census Programs' data calls and oversight requests (e.g., GAO, Office of the Inspector General (OIG)).

4.1.4. Operational Readiness Reviews

The Contractor shall support Operational Readiness Reviews (ORR), which provides the Government confirmation that required capabilities, processes, and resources are prepared for upcoming operational phases or deployments.

The Contractor shall:

1. Schedule and conduct an ORR with Government stakeholders to present readiness evidence and obtain phase-gate approval.
2. Participate in business and technical interchange meetings and support data to ensure agenda items are fully covered.

4.1.5. Soft Launch and Production Validation

The Contractor shall provide soft launch and production validation services to confirm production readiness and ensure that the solution performs as intended under real-world operation conditions prior to full go-live.

The Contractor shall:

1. Schedule and conduct a soft launch in the production environment with Government stakeholders to demonstrate production readiness in a manner that is alignment with real-world production operations, that validates all aspects of the solution in production, in alignment with the Decennial Program's existing soft launch milestone dates, as directed.
2. Replan and conduct new soft launch, if necessary, once any defects have been resolved, as directed.

4.1.6. Lessons Learned Management

The Contractor shall support the collection, analysis, documentation, and application of insights to improve processes, coordination, and performance throughout the life of the procurement.

The Contractor shall:

1. Execute a Lessons Learned Management process that captures insights, findings, and improvement opportunities derived from all procurement-administrative activities (e.g., onboarding, reporting, compliance, invoicing).

2. Capture lessons learned throughout procurement execution.
3. Conduct periodic reviews, including at major program checkpoints, to analyze what worked well, what did not, and what changes are required to improve performance, processes, and coordination across Contractor and Government teams.
4. Incorporate lessons learned into updates of management artifacts, including the CMP, QCP, Staffing Plan, Subcontractor Management Plan, Communications Plan, Transition Plans, and relevant execution-level plans.
5. Maintain a Lessons Learned Log that is version-controlled, and accessible to the Government.
6. Report lessons learned to the Government during regular meetings (weekly, monthly, quarterly), or as otherwise directed.
7. Support Government-led lessons learned activities, workshops, or after-action reviews by providing data, documentation, and personnel participation.

4.1.7. Transition Management

The Contractor shall support a smooth and efficient onboarding process at the start of the procurement and an orderly transition at its conclusion.

4.1.7.1. Transition-In

The Contractor shall support a smooth and efficient start of performance by establishing the personnel, processes, documentation, access, and resources necessary to initiate work under this procurement and to achieve full operational capability without disruption.

The Contractor shall:

1. Establish, document, maintain, and submit a Transition-In Plan (TIP) for review and acceptance.
2. Execute the TIP, with continual tracking of transition activities, including but not limited to status of staff onboarding activities.
3. Participate in the transfer of all applicable knowledge, documentation, artifacts, and operational context from both the Government and, when applicable, from the outgoing Contractor, ensuring continuity of operations and retention of institutional knowledge.
4. Conduct ongoing Transition-In meetings with COR to report progress, address issues, and mitigate risks. Meeting frequency shall be coordinated with the COR based on transition needs.

4.1.7.2. Transition-Out

The Contractor shall support the orderly completion of work at the end of this procurement by ensuring the transfer of knowledge, data, artifacts, documentation, and responsibilities back to the Government, and when applicable, to an incoming Contractor, while maintaining continuity of operations, safeguarding Government information and assets, and closing out all procurement-related activities.

The Contractor shall:

1. Develop, document, implement, maintain, and adhere to a Transition Out Plan (TOP), that ensures an orderly conclusion to the procurement and supports transfer of responsibilities to the Government and, when applicable, the incoming Contractor.
2. Coordinate and work in good faith with the Government and/or the incoming Contractor for an orderly and efficient transition of activities performed under this procurement.
3. Transfer all applicable knowledge, documentation, artifacts, and operational context to the Government and/or the incoming Contractor, ensuring continuity of operations and retention of institutional knowledge.
4. Provide all required close-out documentation, administrative records, and configuration items, including final deliverables, reports, and any other materials requested by the Government.
5. Return all Government-Furnished Equipment (GFE) and Government-Furnished Information (GFI) and ensure removal or secure disposition of Government data from Contractor systems.
6. Coordinate and implement the TOP with the Government and/or incoming Contractor, providing timely and accurate information, data, and support for close-out reviews and audits.
7. Participate in a coordinated close-out effort to address any final Government concerns and confirm completion of all transition and close-out requirements.

4.1.8. Meetings and Reporting

The Contractor shall support consistent, transparent, and actionable communication of procurement status, risks, costs, schedule, staffing, and performance through structured meeting cadences and standardized reporting.

4.1.8.1. Kick-Off Meeting

The Contractor shall:

1. Coordinate and conduct a Kick-Off meeting with the Government at a mutually agreed time and location.
2. Provide meeting materials and status reports to allow for Government review and preparation.
3. Provide the Government with kick-off meeting minutes and an action items list from the meeting.

4.1.8.2. Weekly Status Report and Meeting

The Contractor shall:

1. Submit a written weekly status report (WSR).
2. Conduct a status meeting to present the WSR.

4.1.8.3. Monthly Cost and Schedule Report and Meeting

The Contractor shall:

1. Develop, document, and maintain a Monthly Cost and Schedule Report.
2. Conduct a cost and schedule meeting to present the cost and schedule report.

4.1.8.4. Program Management Review (PMR)

The Contractor shall:

1. Conduct Program Management Reviews (PMR).
2. Ensure appropriate technical, operational, and management personnel from the Contractor's team attend PMRs to support discussion, answer questions, and resolve issues.
3. Produce a list of issues, decisions and action items identified during each PMR and submit the meeting minutes and action item tracking list to the GPMO.

4.1.8.5. Monthly Risk and Issue Reporting

The Contractor shall:

1. Develop, document, and maintain a Monthly Risk and Issue Report.

4.2. Task Area 2 - Technology Execution

The Contractor shall focus on delivering a secure, scalable, and fully integrated technology solution that enables all operational aspects of the 2030 CQA Program. This includes designing, implementing, and maintaining a Census Bureau-authorized Contact Center as a Service (CCaaS) platform, ensuring seamless omni-channel inbound contact routing and handling, and supporting advanced capabilities such as AI-enabled automation. Technology Execution also encompasses rigorous testing and integration processes to validate system performance, security, and compliance, as well as establishing secure data interfaces for accurate and timely information exchange with Government systems. Together, these components form the foundation for reliable, efficient, and high-quality respondent interactions across all supported channels.

Task Area 2 also includes specialized support for non-CQA operations such as Group Quarters, and IVR support for the Recruiting Jobs Line and Field Help Desk.

4.2.1. Contact Center Technology Suite

The Contractor shall implement a comprehensive, secure, scalable, FedRAMP-certified, and Census Bureau-authorized Contact as a Service (CCaaS) solution that enables seamless routing and handling of voice and digital interactions across all supported channels. This includes delivering advanced capabilities such as AI-enabled automation, callback functionality, IVR and chatbot operations, CSR desktop tools, contact recording, analytics, and reporting to meet Government-defined performance standards and SLAs (Attachment J-3).

The Census Bureau anticipates the use of transformative AI tools to support the 2030 CQA program. As these AI tools are adopted and integrated, there must be a commitment to provide timely, accurate, and relevant information using transparent methods while protecting confidentiality. With this focus in mind, the contractor shall:

1. Comply with all applicable federal AI governance requirements, including but not limited to EO 13960, EO 14179, OMB M-25-21, OMB M-25-22, OMB M-26-04, and any superseding or future Executive Orders and OMB guidance, as well as Census Bureau and Department of Commerce AI policies (Attachment J-35 and Attachment J-36).
2. Deliver evidence of compliance with AI governance requirements.

4.2.1.1. Contact Center as a Service (CCaaS)

The Contractor shall:

1. Design, develop, implement and maintain a cloud-native, virtualized FedRAMP-authorized and Census Bureau-authorized CCaaS platform that supports all required voice and digital channels for the 2030 CQA Program.
2. Obtain and maintain ATO for all CCaaS components prior to and through the 2028 Dress Rehearsal and 2030 Census operations in accordance with ATO Requirements for Vendors (Attachment J-29).
3. Ensure the CCaaS solution integrates seamlessly with Government-provided systems (e.g., data collection instrument, questionnaire status, paper fulfillment), including system specifications and protocols.
4. Provide a cloud-based, scalable architecture capable of handling peak volumes without degradation in performance.
5. Implement robust change management and configuration control processes for all CCaaS components.

4.2.1.2. Omni-Channel Inbound Contact Routing

The Contractor shall:

1. Implement an inbound contact acceptance and handling system that:
 - Accepts and processes voice and chat contacts;
 - Routes contacts based on the time of day, day of week, CSR skill groups (language, channel, etc.), and availability; and
 - Provides after-hours, (outside of operational hours) holiday, and emergency messaging.
2. Configure routing logic to prioritize contacts based on Dialed Number Identification Service (DNIS) and apply special treatment (e.g., bypass IVR, priority queue) for designed phone numbers provided by the Government.
3. Enable skills-based routing and dynamic queue management to optimize CSR utilization and meet SLAs.
4. Provide Expected Wait Time (EWT) announcements with configurable thresholds.

5. Provide the ability to integrate voice and chat routing with the CSR Desktop Application to support:
 - Functions for calls and chats as necessary (e.g., answer, hold, terminate, transfer, etc.);
 - Real-time CSR status updates (e.g., available/not available); and
 - Supervisor monitoring of CSR real-time contact performance and state (available/unavailable).
6. Support Computer Telephony Integration (CTI) for synchronized data transfer during all/chat transfers.
7. Capture and transmit para-data for all contacts to the Management Reporting System (MRS).

4.2.1.3. Callback System

The Contractor shall:

1. Implement a callback solution that:
 - Offers callers the option to receive a callback instead of waiting in the queue;
 - Supports immediate callbacks when a CSR becomes available and schedule call backs at a specified time; and
 - Allows respondents to select callback to the originating number or an alternate number.
2. Provide real-time configuration of callback thresholds.
3. Ensure callback functionality for English and Spanish language queues, at a minimum.

4.2.1.4. Interactive Voice Response

The Contractor shall:

1. Deploy an AI-enabled IVR voice-bot solution that:
 - Handles FAQs using natural language understanding (NLU) in English and Spanish languages;
 - Collects and verifies alphanumeric inputs.
 - Supports speech recognition, Dual-Tone Multi-Frequency (DTMF) input, and text-to-speech output;
 - Transfers calls to CSRs upon request or when errors/inactivity occur; and
 - Plays standard and special announcements (e.g., after hours, holiday, emergency, etc.).
2. Ensure consistent voice experience across all automated voice interactions (single voice per language).

3. Integrate IVR with other CCaaS components and Government systems for operational continuity and efficiency.

4.2.1.5. Chatbot and Live Chat Operations

The Contractor shall:

1. Develop and implement AI-enabled chatbots that:
 - Will not store any Personally Identifiable Information (PII) beyond what is required;
 - Understands and responds to natural language inputs using NLU/natural language processing (NLP);
 - Collects and verifies alphanumeric inputs.
 - Are trained exclusively on Government-approved sources and utilize those sources to generate accurate, compliant responses.
 - Identifies and resolves ambiguous user utterances that have a low confidence level in intent classification.
 - Handles multiple simultaneous conversations without performance degradation.
 - Integrates with the Census website and Government-provided data collection instrument.
 - Logs all interactions with timestamps and conversation IDs for escalation and Quality Assurance (QA).
 - Provides reporting on key metrics (e.g., average response time, number of escalations, resolution rates, etc.).
2. Implement an intelligent chatbot capability that proactively learns from Government-defined outreach campaigns and trending high-volume topics to dynamically generate contextually relevant responses using pre-defined responses, mailing strategies, outreach campaigns, and metrics.
3. Ensure chatbot escalations to CSRs occur seamlessly and retain full transcript continuity.
4. Support live chat in English and Spanish languages, at a minimum, with full transcript and video recording of session including post-contact work.

4.2.1.6. Conversational AI

The Contractor shall:

1. Design and implement Conversational AI capabilities to enable intuitive and human-like engagements with respondents.
2. Ensure the Conversational AI collects and verifies alphanumeric inputs.
3. Ensure flexibility for future enhancements that allow integration of emerging AI technologies without requiring major designs.

4. Provide AI-driven intent recognition and classification to accurately interpret respondent inquiries, including ambiguous or multi-part questions, ask clarifying questions (when applicable), handle follow-ups, and route them appropriately.
5. Minimize AI hallucinations and provide non-harmful, non-biased, and compliant responses based on approved Government sources and contents.
6. Enable dynamic learning and improvement by incorporating mechanisms for continuous model training and refinement based on operational data, while adhering to Government security and privacy requirements.
7. Support multi-language conversational AI for English and Spanish languages, at a minimum, with the ability to scale to additional languages as directed by the Government.
8. Integrate AI capabilities with CSR workflows to allow seamless escalation from automated interactions to CSRs, preserving full context and conversation history.

4.2.1.7. AI Enabled Agent Assist

The Contractor shall:

1. Deploy AI-enabled Agent Assist tools that:
 - Provides real-time prompts to CSRs during voice and chat interactions to ensure adherence to scripts and procedures;
 - Collects and verify alphanumeric inputs.
 - Offers dynamic FAQs and recommend responses based on contact context;
 - Alerts CSRs to excessive hold or chat response times;
 - Suggests appropriate actions and responses based on respondent tone, sentiment, and language patterns; and
 - Document and complete the contact records within the CSR Desktop Application.

4.2.1.8. CSR Desktop Application

The Contractor shall:

1. Provide omni-channel support for both phone and chat within one application.
2. Develop and maintain a CSR Desktop Application that:
 - Supports telephony and chat handling functions (e.g., answer, hold, transfer, terminate);
 - Displays AI-enhanced proactive dynamic scripts and FAQs based on predetermined business rules;
 - Integrates with contact routing systems and knowledge management tools;
 - Captures call and agent paradata, including but not limited to contact channel type, timestamps, CSR ID, skills, call reasons, and call resolution;
 - Integrates reports, dashboards, and analytics for user types, enabling CSRs to view their performance in real time.

- Tracks which reference material (e.g., FAQs, Job Aids, etc.) were accessed during a contact; and
- Provides supervisors with real-time monitoring capabilities.

4.2.1.9. Contact Recording

The Contractor shall:

1. Record 100% of voice calls, video sessions, and chat transcripts (including chatbot interactions) from initial greeting through post-contact processing.
2. Retain IVR transcripts of spoken or DTMF input for all IVR interactions.
3. Maintain recordings in a searchable format for the duration of the operations.
4. Deliver all recordings to the Government after operations conclude, in a Census Bureau-approved manner, leveraging cloud-native technology and services to the maximum extent possible.

4.2.2. Testing, Integration, and Deployment Environments

The Contractor shall validate that all technology components meet functional, performance, security, and compliance requirements through structured, comprehensive testing processes, and ensure deployment activities are conducted in secure, scalable, and production-aligned environments. This includes supporting agile testing practices, integration with Decennial systems, and readiness verification for the 2028 Dress Rehearsal and 2030 Census operations, ensuring the solution operates reliably under real-world conditions.

The Contractor shall:

1. Develop, deliver, and maintain a Test Management Plan.
2. Provide agile software testing support to ensure all requirements are tracked through design and satisfied through testing.
3. Perform and document the following test activities:
 - Peer reviews of testing artifacts (e.g., test plans, scripts, results);
 - Performance, regression, end-to-end, integration, System/Solution, and others as identified and approved by the Government;
 - Section 508 and remediation; and
 - Cross-browser and cross-device testing for compatibility and performance across multiple platforms, browsers, and devices as per end-user requirements.
4. Develop and maintain Test Automation Frameworks to reduce manual effort and increase coverage for regression and performance tests.
5. Conduct User Acceptance Testing (UAT) with stakeholders and end-users to validate real-world scenarios and business requirements.

6. Implement comprehensive defect management, including tracking, reporting, prioritizing, and resolution.
7. Establish Test Data Management Procedures to ensure realistic, secure, and compliant test data usage.
8. Utilize continuous testing methodologies within continuous integration and continuous deployment (CI/CD) for automated validation of builds.
9. Provide real-time test reporting and dashboards for visibility into the test status, performance benchmarks, and defect tracking.
10. Develop risk-based testing strategies to prioritize high-risk areas.
11. Facilitate testing in a cloud environment to ensure scalability and reliability.
12. Coordinate and support load and stress testing to validate system performance under peak conditions.
13. Document and archive all test results and artifacts in compliance with federal guidelines for audits & traceability.
14. Perform data migration and validation testing to ensure accuracy and integrity during system transitions.
15. Manage test environments to mirror production configurations and maintain security compliance in accordance with the most current Census/NIST assessment guidance.
16. Provide a cloud SaaS solution for development and testing, initial designs and changes to the production environment.
17. Configure development and test environments to mirror production environment and maintain separate but synchronized environments for development, staging, and testing.
18. Implement automated deployment pipelines to facilitate CI/CD and integrated automated testing tools to validate functionality, performance and security.
19. Ensure development and test environments are patched and updated with latest security measures and implement role-based access control (RBAC) for sensitive resources.
20. Prepare a Readiness Test Analysis Report (RTAR).
21. Establish backup and disaster recovery plans for development and test environments and utilize cloud-based monitoring tools to track performance, security, and usage metrics.
22. Deliver comprehensive documentation that includes test cases, defect reports, and traceability matrices.
23. Participate in integration testing with other Decennial systems and end-to-end integration testing to demonstrate connectivity and readiness for the 2028 Dress Rehearsal and 2030 Census Operation.
24. Coordinate closely with the GPMO to align system engineering efforts with Census System Engineering Management Plan (SEMP) (Attachment J-21).
25. Coordinate closely with the GPMO to develop and deliver artifacts and documentations to meet Decennial Census operational delivery milestones and checkpoints.

4.2.3. Data Interfaces

The Contractor shall establish secure, accurate, and timely data exchange between the Contractor's systems and Government systems to support operational reporting, analytics, and oversight. This includes designing and maintaining interfaces that comply with Census IT security standards and operational needs.

The Contractor shall:

1. Work with the Government to define all data elements required for exchange and reporting.
2. Develop, implement, and maintain secure interfaces to allow for data flow between the Government's and the Contractor's systems.
3. Ensure all data systems comply with Census IT security requirements (Attachment J-28 and Attachment J-30) to transfer data from the Contractor environment for use in standard and ad hoc reporting.
4. Build and secure interfaces, feeds, and integrations following federal mandates to synchronize CSR interactions, contact metadata/paradata, and operational events with the Government case management and analytics systems, in accordance with Census IT security requirements.
5. Implement mechanisms to support standard and custom reporting requests, including real-time and batch data transfers.
6. Provide the Government with access to data necessary for oversight, including potential direct access to Contractor systems for knowledge management articles and contact paradata.
7. Ensure all data used in execution of this procurement remains within CONUS.
8. Maintain auditable logs of all data exchanges and provide these logs to the Government upon request.
9. Support interface testing and validation to confirm accuracy, completeness, and security of data transfers.
10. Update and maintain interface documentation, including data dictionaries, mapping specifications, and change history.
11. Coordinate with the Government to ensure timely updates to interfaces when operational or reporting requirements change.

4.3. Task Area 3 - IT Infrastructure

The Contractor shall provide a secure, scalable, and resilient technology and facility foundation that supports all operational aspects of the 2030 CQA Program. This includes designing and maintaining IT infrastructure capable of handling peak volumes, implementing robust security and compliance controls, enabling remote and on-site operations, and ensuring continuity through contingency and disaster recovery planning.

The Contractor shall also provide specialized support for non-CQA operations such as Group Quarters, and IVR support for the Recruiting Jobs Line and Field Help Desk.

4.3.1. General Infrastructure & Scalability

The Contractor shall deliver a high-performance, fault-tolerant environment that meets Census Bureau security, privacy, and operational requirements while supporting millions of respondent interactions during peak periods. This includes synchronized environments across development, testing, staging, and production, robust scalability, and compliance with all applicable security standards.

The Contractor shall:

1. Locate all production systems and backups within CONUS.
2. Design, develop, and implement a secure, high-capacity network infrastructure (routing, switching, firewalls) that supports all CQA voice, chat, and data traffic with Quality of Service (QoS) guarantees.
3. Support synchronized environments for development, staging, and production to maintain consistency and reduce deployment risks.
4. Ensure infrastructure scalability to handle peak loads and evolving requirements including autoscaling (cloud or virtualized) to absorb sudden volume spikes without manual intervention.
5. Integrate automated testing tools within infrastructure to validate functionality, performance, and security.
6. Maintain compliance with Census Bureau, DOC, and all other federally-mandated security standards across all environments and ensure infrastructure is patched and updated regularly to maintain security posture.
7. Provide redundant Internet-service providers and peering to eliminate single points of failure.
8. Maintain capacity models and support Government-led performance and load-tests to validate infrastructure readiness.
9. Ensure infrastructure supports remote-CSR enablement and centrally managed endpoints. Provide 24x7 monitoring and alerting for availability, performance, and security anomalies.

4.3.2. IT Contingency and Disaster Recovery

The Contractor shall ensure continuity of operations during partial or full system outages through proactive planning, redundancy, and rapid recovery capabilities.

The Contractor shall:

1. Develop, document, and test an IT Contingency Plan (ITCP) in accordance with all Federal requirements.

4.3.3. IT Security

The Contractor shall safeguard Title 13 data and ensure adherence to all applicable federal, DOC and Census mandated Cybersecurity requirements. This includes embedding security controls

into planning, implementation, and operations to uphold confidentiality, integrity, and availability of Census data, while meeting statutory obligations and maintaining public trust.

Title 13 of the United States Code (U.S.C.) authorizes the Census Bureau to collect and maintain data on a broad range of subjects. Title 13 U.S.C. § 9 requires that data collected by the Census Bureau in its surveys, including the Decennial Censuses, shall remain confidential.

The Contractor shall:

1. Comply with all federal confidentiality and privacy policies.
2. Comply with all applicable requirements stated in the following attachments:
 - a. Census Bureau's Information Technology Security Program Policy (Attachment J-28)
 - b. Required Security Controls for Census Bureau Information Systems (Attachment J-32)
 - c. The ATO Requirements for Vendors (Attachment J-29)
 - d. Security Control Assessment Readiness Checklist (Attachment J-33)
 - e. U.S. Census Bureau Risk Management Program Risk Management Framework Methodology (Attachment J-34).

Access to Census Systems will remain restricted for all phases of the project. As Census Bureau systems and type of access are identified through the Testing Phases, the Government will develop requirements associated with access to the Government system. Further IT security requirements can be found in IT Security & Security Management Requirements (Attachment J-30).

4.3.4. Large-Scale Events Preparedness and Response

The Contractor shall ensure continuity of CQA operations during natural disasters, cyber-attacks, or other large-scale disruptions.

The Contractor shall:

1. Develop, maintain, and test Large-Scale Events Preparedness and Response Plan.

4.3.5. Monitoring, Logging & Reporting

The Contractor shall provide continuous visibility into infrastructure performance, security posture, and compliance status.

The Contractor shall:

1. Implement a centralized monitoring platform (e.g., SIEM or APM) to capture performance metrics, logs, and security events across all infrastructure layers.
2. Configure real-time alerts for all cybersecurity events required to meet the six functional areas under the Cybersecurity Framework 2.0 with automated escalation to the Government within one hour for critical incidents.
3. Maintain dashboards for 24x7 operational visibility, accessible to authorized Government personnel, and ensure that single-pane-of-glass dashboard monitoring capability is implemented and available for USCB use.

4. Provide weekly operational reports on availability, capacity utilization, incident trends, and remediation status, plus ad hoc reports upon Government request.
5. Maintain the capability to provide all logging data and events in real-time/near real-time to USCB, as requested.
6. Ensure that all monitoring solutions integrate seamlessly into existing Decennial Program monitoring services and capabilities.

4.4. Task Area 4 - Facilities

The Contractor shall provide secure, compliant, and operationally ready facilities to support 2030 CQA operations. This includes planning & configuration, physical security, and administrative space.

4.4.1. Facility Planning and Configuration

The Contractor shall define requirements for determining, approving, and managing the location and setup of all facilities supporting the 2030 CQA program.

The Contractor shall:

1. Procure, configure, and secure all equipment required to operate Contractor's 2030 CQA solution.
2. Determine the number and locations of CQA facilities, ensuring all are within CONUS.
3. Outfit and obtain approval from the Government prior to occupancy.
4. Decommission the facilities prior to lease end and remove all Government and Contractor property.
5. Provide facilities, with appropriate information and personnel security safeguards to support planning, management, and execution of the 2030 CQA Program and CQA-related activities leading to the 2030 Census.
6. Ensure facilities include, but are not limited to:
 - Administrative Office Space (large conference room with projection system) for meetings;
 - Development and Test facilities;
 - Contact Centers, if applicable;
 - Data Centers, if applicable;
 - Operations Command Center; and
 - Network/Security Operations Center.
7. Coordinate with the COR for any remote performance locations, including temporary authorization for work at Contractor's individual place of residence; however, handing or accessing Title 13 data at a place of residence is strictly prohibited.

4.4.2. Physical Security

The Contractor shall provide a physically secure facility for people, equipment, and documentation. All security requirements apply to the contractor facility, alternative facilities, and any subcontractor facilities.

Considering the requirements of protecting Title 13 and Personally Identifying Information (PII), the Contractor shall:

1. Ensure that the space utilized to support the 2030 CQA program must be kept separate from other operations.
2. Develop physical and logical barriers to ensure that only authorized personnel work in spaces reserved for the Census Bureau.
3. Ensure that contact center and data center computing infrastructure (not including traditionally shared services, such as billing, invoicing, and keeping time) deployed in support of the 2030 CQA program is physically separate from the rest of the contractor's systems.
4. Restrict access to locations where census data are handled to avoid unintentional or accidental disclosure.
5. Ensure that any person requiring access to the physical location where census data is being handled has taken the confidentiality oath. This restriction shall apply to areas such as those containing census questionnaires, facilities or areas where telephone CSRs are conducting interviews and computer rooms with stored census data.
6. Ensure that the space used by the contact center operations features noise cancellation and containment attributes that minimize noise and maintain confidentiality of communication between the CSRs and respondents.
7. Ensure that one respondent cannot overhear information provided by another respondent.
8. Provide for site-specific physical security at all contracted 2030 CQA sites.
9. Work with the Census Bureau to determine the appropriate security controls for each site based on the facility's security level determined by the Office of Security at Census, as well as Physical Environment controls determined by the Office of Information Security at Census.

In addition, all contractor-provided facilities must meet requirements outlined by the Department of Homeland Security (DHS) Interagency Security Committee (ISC) Risk Management Process for Federal Facilities. The process provides the method for determining the facility security level (FSL) based on the characteristics of each facility and the federal occupant(s). Once this phase is complete, it is followed by an appropriate application of countermeasures based on the FSL to mitigate the impact of an undesirable event. It is expected that the Government will not incur the direct cost for countermeasures that are not identified as necessary in the Facility Security Assessment. If the Contractor chooses to implement such countermeasures, it requires approval from the Government. [Attachment J-31](#) provides the US Census Bureau Policies and Procedures Manual - Physical Security.

4.5. Task Area 5 - Asset Management

The Contractor shall ensure proper tracking, maintenance, and decommissioning of all accountable property throughout the 2030 CQA operation.

The Contractor shall:

1. Implement and maintain a comprehensive Government-approved asset management system to track all GFP and CAP throughout its lifecycle.
2. Provide the Government with on-demand access to the asset tracking system.
3. Develop and maintain an Asset Management Plan.
4. Perform monthly inventory reconciliations and support Government audits at any time.
5. Submit a Final Inventory Report.
6. Ensure secure storage and segregation of inventory in access-restricted locations.
7. Implement a lost/stolen/missing/broken device process and report incidents per Section XX.
8. Develop and execute a Decommissioning Plan.
9. Support Supply Chain Risk Assessment for IT hardware/software purchases as requested by the Government.

4.6. Task Area 6 - Operations and Service Delivery

The Contractor shall ensure efficient, secure, and high-quality execution of all CQA operational activities. This includes managing contact center operations, workforce management, quality assurance, safety, and respondent services while adhering to Government-defined standards for performance, security, and customer experience.

4.6.1. Contact Center Operations

The Contractor shall provide responsive, accurate, and secure assistance to respondents through multiple channels, including voice and chat, while meeting Government-defined operational parameters.

Contact center operations include its staffing, management, and organizational structure as well as certain key quality and support functions that are critical to meeting 2030 CQA overall performance requirements. Quality functions include quality at both the individual contact level and at the overall program level. Support functions include contact center groups that focus on enabling CSRs and working to fine-tune performance so that SLAs and overall program requirements can be consistently met. These functional groups include training, QA, and Workforce Management (WFM).

The Contractor shall:

1. Provide CSRs with multilingual support using Government-provided content such as FAQs, scripts, and messaging.

- 1014 2. Provide CSRs with skills, through ongoing training, to handle concurrent conversations
1015 across channels (voice and chat).
- 1016 3. Ensure all operational SOPs and respondent-facing materials are reviewed and approved
1017 by the Government prior to use.
- 1018 4. Support remote location operations as approved by the COR.
- 1019 5. Size operations to meet contact volume SLAs. The Government reserves the right to work
1020 with the Contractor to make changes to the workload model based on financial and
1021 operational needs.

1022 4.6.2. Respondent Services

1023 The Contractor shall provide services offered to respondents contacting the Census Bureau for
1024 assistance. These services should be provided using the technologies within the CCaaS platform,
1025 as described above, as well as customer service representatives described in this section. Some
1026 services, such as questionnaire status and paper questionnaire fulfillment, will require integration
1027 with Government systems and services.

1028 Below is an overview of how the Government is envisioning the respondent services matrix;
1029 however, it may be subject to change.

1030

Respondent Services	IVR	Chatbot	ConAI*	Live Chat	Voice	Integration
General Assistance	●	●	●	●	●	No
Questionnaire Status	●		●		●	Yes
Paper Questionnaire Fulfillment	●		●		●	Yes
Data Collection					●	Yes
Group Quarters	●		●		●	No
Jobs Line	●					No
Field Help Desk	●					No

1031 *ConAI = Conversational AI

1032 The Contractor shall:

- 1033 1. Support general assistance service using the IVR system, chatbot, conversational AI, live
1034 chat, and voice channel using CSRs.
- 1035 2. Support questionnaire status service using the IVR system, conversational AI, and voice
1036 channel using CSRs and systems integration.

- 1037 3. Support paper questionnaire fulfillment service using the IVR system, conversational AI,
1038 and voice channel using CSRs and systems integration.
- 1039 4. Support data collection service through the voice channel using CSRs and systems
1040 integration.
- 1041 5. Support group quarters helpline service using the IVR system, conversational AI, and voice
1042 channel using CSRs.
- 1043 6. Support Jobs Line service using the IVR system.
- 1044 7. Support Field Help Desk service using the IVR system.

1045 **4.6.3. Workforce Management & Command Center**

1046 The Contractor shall ensure adequate staffing, scheduling, and real-time operational oversight
1047 through a Command Center and a WFM System that supports 2030 CQA operations.

1048 The Contractor shall:

- 1049 1. Provide a Command Center that performs centralized functions, such as workforce
1050 management and performance management, across 2030 CQA Contact Center
1051 operations.
- 1052 2. Provide a WFM System customized to support 2030 CQA operations and WFM
1053 management and staff to operate it.
- 1054 3. Ensure the WFM System supports, at a minimum:
- 1055 • Inbound Contact Forecasts;
 - 1056 • CSR Forecasting;
 - 1057 • CSR Scheduling;
 - 1058 • Real-time Adherence to Schedule; and
 - 1059 • Attendance Reporting.
- 1060 4. Produce CSR-related reports, including but not limited to:
- 1061 • Attendance of CSRs;
 - 1062 • Adherence to Schedule;
 - 1063 • Utilization; and
 - 1064 • Productivity.
- 1065 5. Ensure WFM System reports data by CSR, skill set, site, and overall CQA operations level.
- 1066 6. Work with the Government to identify specific reports and timing of those reports.

1067 **4.6.4. Contact Center Staff**

1068 The Contractor shall define the qualifications, structure, and language capabilities necessary to
1069 operate the 2030 CQA contact center effectively. This includes establishing roles for CSRs, Leads,

2030 Census Questionnaire Assistance (2030 CQA)

- 1070 Supervisors, WFM, QA, Training, and other support staff. These requirements ensure that the
1071 Contractor provides a skilled, multilingual workforce capable of meeting SLAs, adhering to
1072 Government policies, and delivering high-quality respondent interactions across all supported
1073 channels.
- 1074 Contact center staff includes CSRs, leads, supervisors, administration, quality monitors, and other
1075 staff needed to operate the contact center operation. Although these were the types of staffing
1076 used during the 2020 CQA operation, the Contractor should determine and justify the structure and
1077 type of staffing needed in their proposed solution.
- 1078 The Contractor shall:
- 1079 1. Determine and justify the structure and type of contact center staffing, including CSRs,
1080 leads, supervisors, administration, quality monitors, and other staff needed to operate the
1081 contact center.
 - 1082 2. Prioritize full-time CSRs to support procurement requirements. However, part-time staff
1083 may be considered for hard-to-fill positions (e.g., CSRs who speak languages other than
1084 English or Spanish) if they do not unreasonably increase the burden on Government
1085 operations or result in higher overall costs.
 - 1086 3. Ensure that CSRs do not service calls for CQA and for non-CQA customers simultaneously.
 - 1087 4. Classify CSRs under the 01420 Survey Worker (Interviewer) Service Contract Act (SCA)
1088 labor category for wage determination purposes.
 - 1089 5. Ensure personnel are compensated in accordance with the wage rates specified in the
1090 2030 CQA Service Contract Act Wage Determinations (Attachment J-13). This wage
1091 determination is updated annually, and the Contractor is responsible for ensuring that
1092 workers are paid the correct rates as established in the most current version.
 - 1093 6. Ensure that CSRs and supervisors meet the following qualifications, at a minimum:
 - 1094 • Are fluent in English, both written and spoken;
 - 1095 • Are fluent in the non-English language they will support, if applicable;
 - 1096 • Are trained on the specific operation they will support;
 - 1097 • Are trained in handling contacts in channels they will support;
 - 1098 • Are proficient in all tools required to properly assist respondents;
 - 1099 • Adhere to the 2030 CQA Contact Center policies and procedures; and
 - 1100 • Are familiar with the 2030 Decennial and their assigned roles.
 - 1101 7. Provide CSR support in all the required languages.
 - 1102 8. Develop and implement a process for testing reading comprehension and spoken American
1103 English fluency for CSRs, leads, and supervisors, as well as verification of job-specific skills
1104 and educational requirements.
 - 1105 9. Provide trained personnel capable of supporting assigned language groups, contact
1106 channels, and roles.

- 1107 10. Verify spoken and written language fluency using recognized industry standards, such as
1108 the Interagency Language Roundtable (ILR) scale, and maintain documentation of
1109 verification. The Government reserves the right to independently verify language
1110 proficiency.
- 1111 11. Ensure that staff members supporting the 2030 Census operations do not perform any
1112 duties not mentioned in this solicitation when scheduled to work directly supporting the
1113 Census Bureau.

1114 **4.6.5. Contact Center Staff Training**

1115 The Contractor shall ensure all staff receive comprehensive, role-based training to perform
1116 required 2030 CQA job functions.

1117 The Contractor shall:

- 1118 1. Develop, deliver, and maintain a comprehensive training program for all staff on required
1119 2030 CQA job functions.
- 1120 2. Submit a Training Plan.
- 1121 3. Develop training materials for initial and updated/continuation training.
- 1122 4. Submit all developed training materials for Government approval at least 20 business days
1123 prior to training delivery.
- 1124 5. Ensure the change management process monitors operating procedures, practices, and
1125 processes to keep all training materials current.
- 1126 6. Update training materials when required by the Government and provide updated training
1127 to CQA Staff at the Government's discretion.
- 1128 7. Provide a training mechanism (in-person, virtual or self-paced on-line) detailing how
1129 training will be delivered, including location of training.
- 1130 8. Ensure facilities include necessary software and equipment to conduct contact center staff
1131 training, if in-person training is recommended.
- 1132 9. Deliver all training through instructor-led (in-person or virtual) or online self-paced
1133 instruction.
- 1134 10. Manage enrollment and the training certification/testing process.
- 1135 11. Plan and execute the training program for Contact Center staff, including development of
1136 the training and class materials, tracking students' progress, and assessment tests.
- 1137 12. Provide the Government, upon request, with assessment of test results and student
1138 training status.
- 1139 13. Describe verification and testing as part of its response to this procurement. The
1140 Government reserves the right to review and approve such test and verification processes
1141 prior to use and monitor during use.

4.6.6. Operational Performance Management

The Contractor shall monitor, measure, and optimize performance across all CQA operations, ensuring adherence to SLAs and quality standards through real-time data and structured processes.

Specialized support for non-CQA operations such as Group Quarters and IVR support for the Recruiting Jobs Line and the Field Help Desk are included in Operational Support Management.

The Contractor shall:

1. Provide staff and resources to support SLA management and measurement.
2. Monitor real-time contact center performance statistics.
3. Monitor real-time skill set (ACD Queue) performance statistics.
4. Monitor real-time performance monitoring of overall 2030 CQA operations.
5. Maintain CSR quality scorecards.
6. Implement performance management standards, methods and procedures.
7. Support command center operations for centralized performance oversight.
8. Provide daily metrics on SLAs during operations.

4.6.7. Operations Analytics and Reporting

The Contractor shall deliver accurate, timely, and actionable insights that enable effective oversight and continuous improvement of CQA operations. This includes implementing advanced analytics solutions to monitor interaction quality, detect deviations, and identify emerging trends, as well as maintaining a centralized MRS for real-time and historical performance data in accordance with the Management Reporting System (MRS) Requirements (Attachment J-9).

The Contractor shall:

1. Implement an analytics solution that:
 - Detects CSR deviations from scripts and flags high-risk interactions;
 - Performs sentiment analysis and identifies trending topics; and
 - Supports QA sampling and escalation based on predefined criteria.
2. Develop and maintain a MRS as a centralized place for accessing all 2030 CQA operations data that:
 - Pulls and consolidates operational data, performance metrics, and deliverables;
 - Provides real-time, near real-time, and historical reporting;
 - Supports custom and ad hoc reporting requests from the Government;
 - Stores performance data for 30 calendar days after the end of each operational phase and maintains deliverables for the life of the procurement; and

- 1175 • Is accessible from a standard web browser from any laptop meeting agreed-upon
- 1176 access control restrictions without requiring additional software or services.
- 1177 3. Gather, process, and present SLA performance data at scheduled review sessions.
- 1178 4. Support periodic Government requests for custom or ad hoc reports by using appropriate
- 1179 tools and techniques for data extraction, manipulation, and presentation.
- 1180 5. Ensure custom reports meet Government-defined specifications for accuracy, timeliness,
- 1181 and format.
- 1182 6. Establish a presence at applicable change and configuration boards.
- 1183 7. Support Independent Verification and Validation (IV&V) verification of calculations and the
- 1184 resulting performance statistics.

1185 **4.6.8. Quality Monitoring and Program-Level Quality Assurance (QA)**

1186 The Contractor shall ensure consistent service quality and compliance with operational standards
1187 across all channels, leveraging AI-enabled tools and robust quality management processes for
1188 2028 Dress Rehearsal and 2030 Census operations.

1189 **4.6.8.1. Omni-Channel Contact Quality Monitoring**

1190 The Contractor shall:

- 1191 1. Develop a comprehensive contact quality monitoring process that includes CSR-handled
- 1192 contacts (Voice Calls and Live Chat) and contacts processed by automated technology
- 1193 (chatbots and voicebots).
- 1194 2. Utilize AI-enabled Quality Monitors to analyze and establish a quality score for all contacts
- 1195 (voice calls, live chats, voicebots and chatbots).
- 1196 3. Include all AI entities in the Quality Monitoring program, such as chatbot, voicebot, AI
- 1197 Enabled CSR Assist, and conversational AI.
- 1198 4. Measure CSRs and all AI entities on the accuracy and completeness of information
- 1199 provided to respondents.
- 1200 5. Include AI-enabled CSR Assist in the contact monitoring plan, covering all information,
- 1201 alerts, and instructions sent to CSRs and whether CSR behavior was modified based on
- 1202 prompts.
- 1203 6. Include a virtual coach function that is an automated means of providing contact quality
- 1204 monitoring, scoring feedback, and coaching to CSRs.
- 1205 7. Develop an ongoing sampling methodology to oversee the functioning and quality
- 1206 measurement of:
 - 1207 • AI-enabled Quality Monitors;
 - 1208 • Quality Feedback/Contact Coaching;
 - 1209 • Voicebot;
 - 1210 • Chatbot; and

- 1211 • CSR Assist.

1212 4.6.8.2. Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)

1213 The Contractor shall ensure consistency, efficiency, and compliance across the program by
1214 developing, implementing, and maintaining comprehensive SOPs that serve as the foundation for
1215 standardized workflows, regulatory adherence, and quality assurance.

1216 The Contractor **shall**:

- 1217 1. Develop, implement and maintain a complete and comprehensive set of required SOPs
1218 that are clear, practical, and adaptable to evolving operational needs.
- 1219 2. Ensure SOPs specify guidelines, cost-effective, and repeatable practices for day-to-day and
1220 other scheduled operations.
- 1221 3. Include in every SOP, at a minimum:
 - 1222 • Objectives;
 - 1223 • Scope;
 - 1224 • Organizational structure performing the work;
 - 1225 • Roles & responsibilities; and
 - 1226 • Detailed procedures to be followed to successfully perform the tasks, including means
1227 of documenting the work and its results, triggers that cause the SOP to be enabled
1228 (where applicable), exceptions, escalation procedures, and criteria to measure
1229 success of the results.
- 1230 4. Document requirements for timely communication of relevant information (including
1231 updates, escalations) to the Contractor and the Census Bureau staff.
- 1232 5. Ensure Government approval of all agreed-upon SOPs and updates prior to
1233 implementation.
- 1234 6. Follow only Government-approved policies and procedures, when appropriate.
- 1235 7. Align SOPs with industry best practices and Government policies, where applicable.
- 1236 8. Establish a formal review and approval process with the Government to ensure SOPs
1237 remain accurate and effective.
- 1238 9. Review and update, as needed, and incorporate stakeholder feedback.
- 1239 10. Maintain the SOPs in the centralized, easily accessible, knowledge management system
1240 with a version control system in place to track updates, approvals, and historical changes.
- 1241 11. Archive outdated SOPs while ensuring only the latest versions are in use.
- 1242 12. Evaluate SOP effectiveness using appropriate metrics, audits, and feedback mechanisms.

1243 4.6.8.3. Knowledge Management

1244 The Contractor shall maintain accurate and up-to-date information resources for contact center
1245 staff.

1246 The Contractor shall:

- 1247 1. Develop and maintain a centralized knowledge base accessible to all contact center staff.
1248 2. Ensure timely updates to FAQs, script, and reference materials as approved by the
1249 Government.
1250 3. Ensure content in the knowledge base is searchable by the authorized users.

1251 **4.6.9. Technical Close-Out**

1252 The Contractor shall ensure an orderly, secure, and complete transition of technical assets,
1253 access, data, and documentation at the conclusion of 2030 CQA Operations. During the close-out
1254 period, the Contractor is responsible for executing a coordinated ramp-down of operations,
1255 including the reduction of staffing and workloads, the collection and delivery of all final technical
1256 and operational deliverables, and the Government-directed disassembly, transition, or destruction
1257 of systems, infrastructure, and information. These activities are to be performed in a manner that
1258 ensures continuity of Government operations, preserves data integrity, and supports the
1259 Government's ability to validate, secure, and assume control of all technical assets and
1260 information at procurement end.

1261 The following requirements outline the technical activities and supporting actions necessary to
1262 meet the Government's expectations for a complete and compliant technical close-out.

1263 The Contractor shall:

- 1264 1. Provide a Technical Close-Out Plan.
1265 2. Ensure that all information assets and related configuration information are current and
1266 available for Government no later than 90 calendar days prior to procurement end.
1267 3. Turn over all administrative access information (e.g., usernames and passwords) to the
1268 Government no later than 90 calendar days prior to procurement end.
1269 4. Return all Government Furnished Equipment (GFE) to the Government.
1270 5. After CQA operations conclude, decommission all contact center systems and facilities
1271 and provide a comprehensive analysis of the CQA program to support procurement close-
1272 out activities.
1273 6. Track, document, and report the physical disposition of all equipment throughout
1274 decommissioning to verify:
1275 • Equipment is properly removed from the CQA program,
1276 • Equipment is fully accounted for,
1277 • Equipment status is reflected in the Final Inventory Report.
1278 7. At the request of the Government, remove all Census-related data from Contractor
1279 systems.
1280 8. Develop, maintain, and update comprehensive decommissioning and media sanitization
1281 procedures consistent with the Decommissioning Plan.
1282 9. Return all devices for reuse or process them for close-out in accordance with the
1283 Government-approved schedule.

- 1284 10. Perform media sanitization and factory reset for all equipment, including non-GFE
1285 equipment, that will be removed from the program and not reused, in accordance with NIST
1286 SP 80088 (current revision as adopted by USCB) and the USCB IT Security Program Policy.
1287 Sanitization shall occur:
- 1288 • Prior to shipment from Decennial locations to the Contractor facility (when feasible)
 - 1289 • Upon Decennial location close-out and final close-out of 2030 Census Operations
 - 1290 • At the request of GPMO/USCB
- 1291 11. Document all sanitization activities in an Equipment/Device Sanitization Log within three (3)
1292 business days of receipt. All entries must be approved by the GPMO or designee(s), be
1293 maintained electronically, and be available for Government review.
- 1294 12. Conduct post-sanitization quality control (QC) checks on 100% of equipment to confirm:
- 1295 • Removal of all USCB and Title 13 data
 - 1296 • Removal of all required software
 - 1297 • Completion of full media sanitization and factory reset prior to redistribution or final
1298 disposition.
- 1299 13. Maintain proof of sanitization and any required COR certifications.
- 1300 14. When data is not encrypted and sanitization cannot be completed prior to shipment, ship
1301 equipment via USCB-approved methods that protect Title 13 data, sanitize upon receipt at
1302 the Contractor facility.
- 1303 15. Ensure all sanitization processes and controls meet applicable requirements, including:
- 1304 • NIST SP 800-88 (current revision): Guidelines for Media Sanitization
 - 1305 • Census Bureau Cybersecurity Policy (CBCP) media sanitization requirements
 - 1306 • FAR 39.101(d) regarding NIST common security configuration checklists
1307 (e.g., FDCC/USGCB)
 - 1308 • HSPD-12 requirements per FAR 4.1302 and FIPS 201 (use only approved personal
1309 identity verification products/services; acquisition via GSA SIN as applicable)
 - 1310 • IPv6 requirements per FAR 11.002(g), including reference to the USGv6
1311 Profile and USGv6 Test Program (as applicable to the acquisition and agency Enterprise
1312 Architecture)

END OF SECTION

1313